Provider License Verification SOP

State board verification and evidence review

Use this procedure to verify a reported U.S. physician license with the issuing board and pass a documented result to credentialing or enrollment. The worked example uses a California physician and surgeon license. Apply the relevant board, profession and client rules to other cases.

Ownership. The analyst runs the lookup and logs the evidence. A reviewer checks the identity, board status, evidence and exception decision. The team lead routes restrictions, unresolved conflicts and decisions that require client or compliance input.

Verification procedure

1. Confirm the scope. Open a tracker row for each license and jurisdiction. Record the case ID, legal name, known name variants, board, profession, license type and reported license number. Confirm the practice states and priority with the client.

2. Search the issuing board. Go from the official board website to its designated lookup. For a California MD, use the Medical Board of California physician and surgeon search. For a California DO, the Board directs readers to the Osteopathic Medical Board. Search by license number first. Use the board's name search and known variants to investigate an absent or conflicting result. [L1]

3. Match the person and license. Compare issuing board, license number and type, and the licensee name. Confirm a documented legal name variation through an approved channel. A same-name result or a similar specialty is insufficient to establish identity. Preserve the submitted and source values as separate fields.

4. Capture the board result. Record status exactly as displayed, expiration date, visible restrictions or orders, and the board's data timestamp if shown. Review relevant board orders and scope before asking the reviewer to clear the item. The California public profile has disclosure and update limits. [L1–L2]

5. Log the evidence. Record the search URL, date, time and time zone, analyst, permitted evidence reference and comparison result. Use the approved evidence store and limit the tracker to references and operational facts. Review the outcome against the rules on page 2.

Portfolio example. For fictional physician PRV-001, VER-001 records a simulated California license match and VER-002 a simulated NPI identity match on November 6, 2026. VER-003 remains open for a CME course completion certificate due November 12 under a sample client renewal-readiness review.

Exceptions and release

Use the result to describe the search or comparison and the reviewer status to describe the workflow decision. Leave the result Pending until a search is attempted. A Match confirms the scoped fields agree. The reviewer evaluates whether the status and any visible restrictions meet the intended use.

Observed condition	Tracker action	Resolution or routing
Unique match with acceptable board status	Result Match. Reviewer Pending until review.	Check scope, expiry and evidence. Set reviewer Cleared after sign-off and send the evidence reference to the request owner.
Conflicting identifiers or ambiguous name	Result Mismatch. Hold release.	Compare raw values, confirm the legal name or license number securely, then repeat the board search. Escalate unresolved ambiguity.
No matching result after available checks	Result No record. Hold release.	Reconfirm the board and license type. Record search attempts and request clarification or official verification.
Portal failure or source inaccessible	Result Unavailable. Hold release.	Record the outage and retry date. Use the board's published contact route or formal verification channel.
Expired, restricted or adverse board status	Preserve board wording and identity result. Set reviewer Escalated.	Send evidence to the lead and keep the downstream release on hold. Follow the authorized decision on the scope of use.

Monitoring and handoff

For every open item, assign one owner, next action and follow-up date. Keep the client's target and any board deadline separate. If a later lookup changes the status or expiration, add the new evidence with its date and reopen the downstream review when the change affects release.

NPI identity and CME evidence belong on separate rows when they are in scope. Use the CMS NPPES NPI Registry for the identity comparison. The CMS fact sheet describes the limits of enumeration. [L3, L5] Review CME against the board's renewal cycle and applicable conditions if the client asks for renewal readiness. Treat missing documentation as an evidence gap. [L4]

Evidence record and source register

Keep the source observation, comparison result and reviewer decision independently auditable. Retain the original evidence reference when a correction or later lookup supersedes it.

Evidence field group	Minimum capture
Search and identity	Case and check IDs, jurisdiction, board, profession, license type, search keys and source URL.
Observation	Source status and dates as displayed, result notes, visible restriction or order reference, observation timestamp with time zone, analyst and permitted evidence locator.
Disposition	Result and reviewer status, reviewer and decision date, linked exception, open owner and follow-up, or release recipient and date.

Official sources

All sources accessed November 10, 2026.

[L1] Medical Board of California | License Verification

Identifies official search options and routes California DO checks to the osteopathic board. California only.

www.mbc.ca.gov/License-Verification/

[L2] Medical Board of California | License Lookup Disclosure

Explains information omitted from the public profile and possible posting delays. Absence of a public item does not establish its absence elsewhere.

www.mbc.ca.gov/License-Verification/lookup-disclosure.aspx

[L3] CMS | NPI Fact Sheet

Describes Type 1 and Type 2 NPIs. NPI assignment establishes enumeration. Licensing, credentialing and enrollment require separate evidence.

www.cms.gov/files/document/npi-fact-sheet.pdf

[L4] Medical Board of California | Continuing Medical Education

Explains biennial CME, approved education and waivers for the covered license. Review specialty, topic and provider-specific provisions.

www.mbc.ca.gov/Licensing/Physicians-and-Surgeons/Renew/Current-Status/Continuing-Medical-Education.aspx

[L5] CMS | NPPES NPI Registry

Public lookup for enumeration records. Individual record checks in the portfolio are simulated.

npiregistry.cms.hhs.gov/